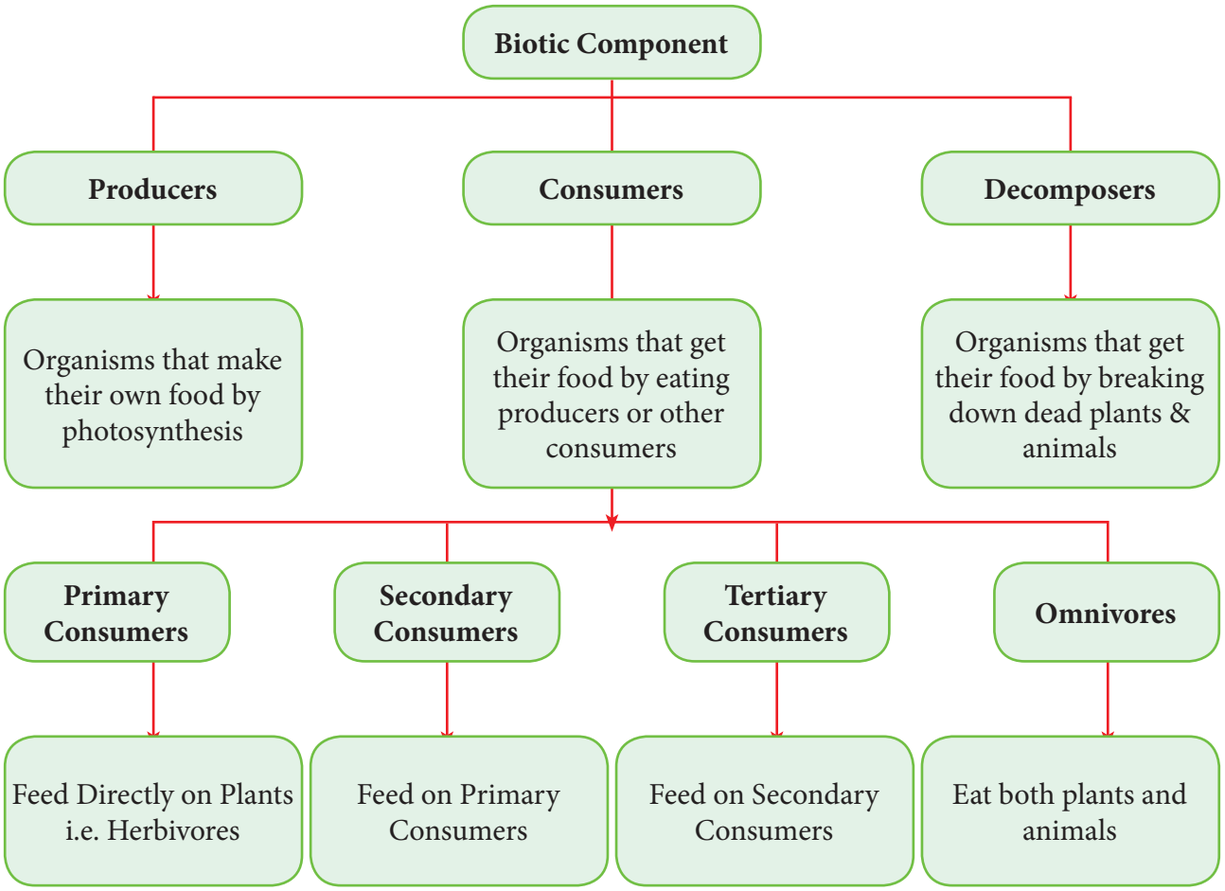


Figure 7.2 Biotic Components

grasshopper,sheep, goat, cow, rabbit, deer, elephant etc. Examples of aquatic herbivores are zoo plankton, krill, squid, small fish, sea urchin, etc.

2. **Secondary Consumers**
Animals that kill and eat the herbivores or plant eating animals are called secondary consumers. They are also called as '*carnivores*', Example; lion, tiger, fox, frog, snak, spider, crocodile, etc.

3. **Tertiary Consumers**
They are top predators in a food chain. They are carnivores at the topmost level in a food chain that feed on other carnivores or secondary consumers. Example: an owl eats a snake but an owl is eaten by a hawk, therefore a hawk is a tertiary consumer. Tertiary consumers that occupy the top trophic level, and are not predated by any other animals are called '*apex predators*'. However, when they die their bodies will be consumed by scavengers besides the decomposers Example; alligator andhawk.

Some organisms eat both plants and animals. These animals are called as'*omnivores*. Example; cockroach, fox, seagull and human.

Some omnivores are '*scavengers*', which eat food that other animals have left behind Example; hyena and vultures.

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